NORTHSTAR COLLEGE
OF APPLIED STUDIES

STUDENT POLICY HANDBOOK

Academic year 2026-2027 | Demonstration edition 1.0

IMPORTANT - FICTIONAL DEMONSTRATION DOCUMENT
This handbook was created solely as sample knowledge-base content for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) learning project. Northstar College of Applied Studies is fictional. All rules, dates, thresholds, fees, and procedures in this document are invented examples. They are not the rules of a real institution and must not be relied on for actual academic decisions.

Document information

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Designed for testing PDF text extraction, page-aware chunking, semantic retrieval, source references, and grounded question answering.

1. About this handbook

This handbook brings together selected academic and student-service rules for the fictional Northstar College of Applied Studies. It is organized into short policy sections with identifiers so that a document-processing system can extract, split, retrieve, and cite each section independently.

1.1 Scope

The sample rules apply to fictional undergraduate students enrolled in regular on-campus programmes. They cover attendance, leave, assessment, examinations, assignments, academic integrity, library use, information technology, accessibility support, and student grievances. A real institution may have separate rules for postgraduate programmes, professional placements, research degrees, distance learning, or programmes governed by an external regulator.

1.2 How to read a policy

Each policy section has a unique identifier, such as ATT-01 or EXM-02. The identifier is included to make it easier to refer to a rule and trace an answer to its source. Where a rule says that approval is required, an application does not automatically mean that approval has been granted.

1.3 Key terms

Term	Meaning in this sample handbook
Academic working day	A day when the college administrative offices are open; weekends and listed college holidays are excluded.
Course	A taught subject or module taken by a student during a semester.
Condonation	A formal, exceptional approval that may excuse a limited attendance shortage when the stated conditions are met.
Duty leave	An approved attendance adjustment for a student officially representing the college in an authorized activity.
Internal assessment	Marks awarded during the semester through tests, assignments, projects, or other announced work.
Working day	A day on which the relevant college office is open.

1.4 Responsibilities

- Students are responsible for reading the current policy, meeting deadlines, and checking official notices.
- Course instructors communicate course-level assessment schedules and maintain attendance records.
- The Academic Administration Office maintains the sample handbook and coordinates formal policy queries.
- The relevant committee or designated officer makes decisions where a policy requires formal approval.

Use of this document
For the RAG project, answers should identify the relevant policy section and page. If the document does not contain an answer, the assistant should say that the information was not found rather than inventing a rule.

2. Attendance and leave

Attendance is recorded separately for each course. Students should review their attendance regularly and report any recording error promptly.

ATT-01 | MINIMUM ATTENDANCE

Minimum attendance for examination eligibility

A student must attend at least **75% of the scheduled instructional sessions in each course** to be eligible to sit the end-semester examination for that course. Attendance is calculated course by course; a high attendance percentage in one course does not make up for a shortage in another course.

ATT-02 | ATTENDANCE CALCULATION

How attendance is calculated

The attendance percentage is calculated as: sessions attended divided by total sessions conducted for the course, multiplied by 100. Sessions officially cancelled by the college are not counted in the total. A student should contact the course instructor within five academic working days after a suspected attendance-record error is noticed.

ATT-03 | ATTENDANCE SHORTAGE

Attendance shortage and condonation

A student whose attendance is between **65% and 74.99%** may submit a condonation request with supporting evidence. Approval is not automatic and depends on review by the Academic Attendance Committee. A student below 65% is normally not eligible for condonation under this sample policy. The committee may consider an exception only where a separate institutional or regulatory authorization permits it.

LEV-01 | PLANNED LEAVE

Applying for planned leave

A student should submit a leave request to the course instructor or designated student office before the planned absence. The request should state the dates, reason, courses affected, and any supporting documents. Approval should be obtained before the leave begins whenever reasonably possible.

LEV-02 | MEDICAL LEAVE

Medical leave and supporting evidence

Where illness or an emergency prevents advance notice, the student should inform the college as soon as reasonably possible. A medical certificate or other appropriate evidence should be submitted within **three academic working days after the student returns**. The college may ask for clarification where the submitted evidence is incomplete.

LEV-03 | EFFECT OF LEAVE

Does approved leave count as attendance?

Ordinary approved personal or medical leave does not automatically count as class attendance. Only a separately approved duty-leave adjustment under policy DUT-01 may be added to the attendance record. Students remain responsible for missed lessons and assessments.

DUT-01 | OFFICIAL DUTY LEAVE

Duty leave for official college representation

A student officially selected to represent the college in an approved academic, sports, cultural, or service event may request duty leave. The event coordinator must certify participation, and the designated academic officer must approve the attendance adjustment. The adjustment applies only to the dates and sessions listed in the approval.

3. Assessment and grading

Assessment methods and weightings should be communicated to students at the beginning of each course. Individual course documents may specify the schedule and submission format, provided they remain consistent with the approved course assessment plan.

ASM-01 | ASSESSMENT STRUCTURE

Standard assessment structure

For this demonstration handbook, each course is assessed out of **100 marks**. Internal assessment contributes **40 marks**, and the end-semester examination contributes **60 marks**. The course instructor must publish the assessment plan, including dates, topics, and evaluation criteria, before assessed work begins.

Component	Maximum marks	Description
Internal Test 1	15	A scheduled written or approved online test.
Internal Test 2	15	A second test covering the announced course content.
Assignment or project	10	An individual or group task with a published rubric.
End-semester examination	60	A centrally scheduled examination.
Total	100	40 internal + 60 end-semester.

ASM-02 | PASSING REQUIREMENT

Minimum passing requirement

A student must obtain at least **40 marks out of 100 overall** and at least **24 marks out of 60 in the end-semester examination** to pass the course. Meeting the overall mark requirement alone is not sufficient if the end-semester minimum is not met.

ASM-03 | PUBLICATION OF MARKS

Reviewing assessment marks

Internal assessment marks should normally be shared with students within ten academic working days after the assessment. Students may request clarification from the course instructor within five academic working days after marks are published. A request for clarification is not itself a guarantee that marks will change.

ASM-04 | ABSENCE FROM AN ASSESSMENT

Missing an internal assessment

A student who misses an internal assessment due to illness or another serious reason should notify the course instructor or student office within two academic working days. Supporting evidence may be required. A make-up assessment may be arranged only when approved by the designated academic officer and when the course assessment plan permits it.

ASM-05 | GRADE REVIEW

Requesting a grade review

A student who believes that an assessment has been marked incorrectly may submit a written review request within seven academic working days after the marks are released. The request should identify the course, assessment, and specific item for review. The review checks for marking or recording errors; it is not an automatic re-assessment of academic judgment.

4. Examinations and assignments

Students must follow the examination instructions and the assessment requirements communicated by the college. The rules below are sample procedures for the fictional institution.

EXM-01 | EXAMINATION ENTRY

Hall ticket and identity verification

Students must bring a valid college identity card and the hall ticket or approved examination entry document to every end-semester examination. A student who cannot produce one of these items should report to the chief examination officer before the examination begins. Entry may be delayed while identity is verified.

EXM-02 | REPORTING TIME

When to arrive for an examination

Students should arrive at the examination venue at least **30 minutes before** the scheduled start time. Students arriving after the question paper has been distributed must obtain permission from the chief examination officer. No additional examination time is provided solely because a student arrived late.

EXM-03 | PERMITTED MATERIALS

Materials allowed in the examination hall

Students may bring only the materials listed in the examination instructions. A calculator is permitted only when the course or examination instructions expressly allow it. Notes, textbooks, smart watches, phones, earphones, and other electronic communication devices must be kept outside the examination workspace unless specifically authorized in writing.

EXM-04 | EXAMINATION CONDUCT

Conduct during an examination

Students must follow invigilator instructions, remain in the assigned seat, and avoid communicating with other candidates. A student who needs assistance should raise a hand and wait for an invigilator. Disruptive behavior may be reported to the chief examination officer.

EXM-05 | MALPRACTICE

Suspected examination malpractice

Possessing unauthorized material, copying, communicating without permission, impersonation, or interfering with examination procedures may be treated as suspected malpractice. The invigilator should record the incident and refer it to the Examination Discipline Committee. The student must be given an opportunity to provide an explanation before a disciplinary finding is made.

ASN-01 | ASSIGNMENT DEADLINES

Submitting assignments on time

Assignments must be submitted through the method and by the deadline announced by the course instructor. Where a digital submission portal is used, the timestamp recorded by the portal is treated as the submission time. Students should keep a copy or submission receipt.

ASN-02 | LATE SUBMISSION

Late assignment submissions

An assignment submitted up to **two calendar days** after the deadline may be accepted with a deduction of **10% of the available assignment marks**. After two calendar days, the assignment is normally not accepted unless an extension was approved before the deadline or an exceptional circumstance is accepted by the designated academic officer. A course-specific approved assessment plan may set a different rule if announced in advance.

ASN-03 | EXTENSION REQUESTS

Requesting an assignment extension

A student should request an extension before the deadline and explain the reason with supporting evidence where appropriate. The instructor may approve, refuse, or set a revised deadline in accordance with the course assessment plan. Submitting an extension request does not automatically extend the deadline.

5. Academic integrity

Academic integrity means completing academic work honestly, acknowledging the work of others, and following the assessment instructions. Students are responsible for understanding what collaboration, citation, and tool use are permitted for each task.

INT-01 | PLAGIARISM

Plagiarism and proper acknowledgement

Plagiarism includes presenting another person's words, ideas, code, design, or work as one's own without appropriate acknowledgement. Direct quotations should be clearly identified and cited. Paraphrased material must also acknowledge its source. Reusing another student's submitted work without permission and attribution may be treated as plagiarism.

INT-02 | UNAUTHORIZED COLLABORATION

Individual and group work

Students may discuss course concepts unless the instructor says otherwise. Work designated as individual must be written and submitted independently. Students must not share completed answers, files, or code for another student to submit as their own. Group work should identify the contributions required by the assignment instructions.

INT-03 | USE OF AI TOOLS

Artificial intelligence tools in coursework

Students may use generative AI tools only to the extent permitted by the course instructor and the specific assignment instructions. Where AI assistance is permitted, students must disclose the tool and the type of assistance when the instructions require disclosure. Students remain responsible for checking factual accuracy, citing original sources, and ensuring that the submitted work reflects the required learning outcomes. AI output must not be represented as verified source material without checking it.

INT-04 | FABRICATED INFORMATION

Fabrication and falsification

Inventing experimental results, attendance records, survey responses, references, certificates, or other evidence is prohibited. Altering an official academic record or submitting false supporting documents may be referred for disciplinary review.

INT-05 | ACADEMIC INTEGRITY PROCESS

Review of an integrity concern

When a possible integrity breach is reported, the course instructor should preserve relevant evidence and refer the matter to the Academic Integrity Panel. The student should receive a written summary of the concern and a reasonable opportunity to respond. The panel should consider the available evidence, the student's response, the assessment instructions, and the seriousness of the conduct before recommending an outcome.

INT-06 | POSSIBLE OUTCOMES

Possible academic integrity outcomes

Depending on the findings and severity, outcomes may include an educational warning, a requirement to resubmit work, a mark penalty for the affected assessment, a zero mark for the affected assessment, or referral for formal disciplinary action. The outcome should be recorded and communicated in writing. This sample handbook does not prescribe an automatic penalty for every case.

Important distinction
A similarity score from a text-matching tool is an indicator for review, not proof of plagiarism by itself. Any decision should consider the actual content, citations, assignment instructions, and the student's explanation.

6. Student support and grievances

The college should provide clear channels for students to request support, report concerns, and seek review of administrative or academic decisions.

SUP-01 | ACCESSIBILITY SUPPORT

Requesting learning or examination accommodations

A student who needs an accommodation for a disability, temporary injury, or documented learning support requirement should contact the Student Support Office. Where possible, the request should be submitted at least **ten academic working days before** the relevant examination or activity. The request should describe the support needed and include appropriate supporting information. The office will review the request and communicate an approved arrangement where feasible.

SUP-02 | EXAMINATION ACCOMMODATIONS

Examples of possible examination accommodations

Depending on the documented need and the assessment requirements, approved arrangements may include accessible seating, a suitable writing environment, assistive technology, additional time, or an alternative accessible format. No accommodation is automatic; it must be reviewed and confirmed by the Student Support Office and the relevant academic authority.

GRV-01 | SUBMITTING A GRIEVANCE

How to submit a student grievance

A student may submit a grievance about an academic process, administrative service, facilities issue, or alleged unfair treatment to the Student Helpdesk or Academic Administration Office. The submission should include the student's name and contact details, the issue, relevant dates, the outcome requested, and copies of relevant evidence. Students should normally submit the grievance within **seven academic working days** after the event or decision.

GRV-02 | ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AND RESPONSE

Grievance acknowledgement and target response

The receiving office should acknowledge a grievance within **two academic working days**. The normal target is to provide an initial written response or an update within **ten academic working days**. Complex matters may require more time; in that case, the office should tell the student why additional time is needed and provide an expected update date.

GRV-03 | ESCALATION

Escalating an unresolved grievance

If a student is not satisfied with the initial response, the student may request escalation to the Student Grievance Committee within five academic working days after receiving the response. The committee should review the original submission, the office response, and any additional information provided by the student. The committee's written outcome should explain the decision and any next step available under the applicable institutional process.

SUP-03 | CONFIDENTIALITY

Handling student support information

Student support and grievance information should be shared only with staff who need it to assess or resolve the request, subject to applicable law and institutional procedure. Students should avoid including unnecessary sensitive personal information in general helpdesk messages.

7. Library, technology, and campus conduct

Students are expected to use college facilities and digital services responsibly. The following examples support common policy questions in the demonstration knowledge base.

LIB-01 | BORROWING LIMIT

Library borrowing allowance

An eligible student may borrow up to **four books at a time** using a valid college identity card. The standard borrowing period is **14 calendar days**. Reference books, rare materials, and items marked for library use only may not be borrowed for use outside the library.

LIB-02 | RENEWAL

Renewing a library book

A borrowed book may be renewed once for a further 14 calendar days if no other user has placed a reservation on it. Renewal must be completed on or before the due date. A book that is overdue or reserved by another user is not eligible for renewal under this sample rule.

LIB-03 | OVERDUE ITEMS

Overdue library book charge

The sample overdue charge is **INR 2 per book for each calendar day** after the due date. The charge stops accruing when the book is returned or the library records an approved exception. Students should contact library staff if a returned item continues to appear as overdue in their account.

IT-01 | ACCOUNT SECURITY

Protecting college accounts

Students must keep passwords confidential, use multi-factor authentication where it is provided, and sign out from shared devices. Students must not attempt to access another person's account, bypass access controls, distribute malicious software, or disrupt college systems. Suspected account compromise should be reported to the IT Helpdesk promptly.

IT-02 | ACCEPTABLE USE

Responsible use of college technology

College networks and equipment should be used for lawful educational, research, administrative, and other authorized purposes. Users must respect copyright, privacy, and information-security requirements. Large downloads, automated traffic, or other activity that disrupts shared services may be restricted by the IT team.

CON-01 | CAMPUS CONDUCT

Respectful behavior on campus

Students should treat other students, staff, visitors, and service personnel with respect. Harassment, threats, intimidation, discrimination, deliberate damage to property, and repeated disruption of teaching or college services may be referred through the appropriate student conduct process.

CON-02 | LOST PROPERTY

Reporting lost property

A student who finds property on campus should hand it to the Campus Services Desk or another designated office. A student who loses property may submit a description, location, and approximate time to the same desk. The college may ask the claimant to verify ownership before returning an item.

8. Policy administration and quick reference

ADM-01 | POLICY UPDATES

Reviewing and updating this handbook

The Academic Administration Office should review this sample handbook annually and whenever a significant academic or regulatory change occurs. Each approved revision should include a version number, approval date, effective date, and a summary of changes. Students should check the latest published version rather than relying on an old downloaded copy.

ADM-02 | CONFLICTING INFORMATION

When another official notice differs from this handbook

For this fictional demonstration, a later dated, formally approved college notice takes precedence over an earlier handbook provision where the notice explicitly identifies the provision it changes. A course-specific assessment plan may provide additional details but should not silently override an institution-wide requirement. Where two documents appear to conflict and neither clearly takes precedence, the student should request clarification from the Academic Administration Office.

ADM-03 | QUESTIONS AND CONTACT ROUTE

Where to ask for clarification

Questions about attendance, leave, assessments, and examinations should first be directed to the course instructor or Academic Administration Office. Questions about accessibility support should be directed to the Student Support Office. Library questions should be directed to library staff. Account and network issues should be reported to the IT Helpdesk. Grievances should follow policies GRV-01 to GRV-03.

Quick reference: sample policy facts

Question	Sample rule
What attendance is required?	At least 75% in each course (ATT-01).
What shortage may be considered for condonation?	65% to 74.99%; approval is not automatic (ATT-03).
When is medical evidence due?	Within three academic working days after returning (LEV-02).
What is the assessment split?	40 internal marks and 60 end-semester marks (ASM-01).
What is the end-semester minimum to pass?	24 out of 60, plus 40 out of 100 overall (ASM-02).
How early should students arrive for exams?	At least 30 minutes before the start (EXM-02).
How many days late can an assignment be accepted under the sample rule?	Up to two calendar days, with a 10% deduction (ASN-02).
How many books can a student borrow?	Up to four books for 14 calendar days (LIB-01).
What is the grievance acknowledgement target?	Two academic working days (GRV-02).

RAG project testing note

When answering a question, retrieve the smallest relevant policy section, include its policy ID and page number in the source metadata, and answer only what the retrieved text supports. If the policy does not answer the question, say so clearly. These sample values are intentionally fictional and should never be presented as real college rules.

End of demonstration handbook